UI/UX Design Basics

Clear, accessible, user-friendly interface foundations

CampusConnect • Student Learning Resource

UI and UX

- UI is the visual and interactive elements people use.
- UX is how effectively and comfortably people achieve their goals.
- Start by understanding the user and their task.

Visual hierarchy

- Use size, weight, spacing, and placement to show what matters most.
- Give each page a clear heading and group related information.
- Avoid making every element compete for attention.

Spacing, alignment, and color

- Use a consistent spacing scale and align related elements.
- Ensure text contrasts clearly with its background.
- Do not rely on color alone for status; include a label or icon.

Responsive design

- Use flexible layouts and test small screens, long text, and touch targets.
- Make important actions easy to find on mobile.

Accessibility

- Use semantic HTML and meaningful button labels.
- Provide alt text for informative images and visible keyboard focus.
- Use headings in a logical order and label form fields.

Design review

- Can users identify the page purpose quickly?
- Is the main action easy to find?
- Are loading and error states clear?
- Does the layout work on mobile and with a keyboard?